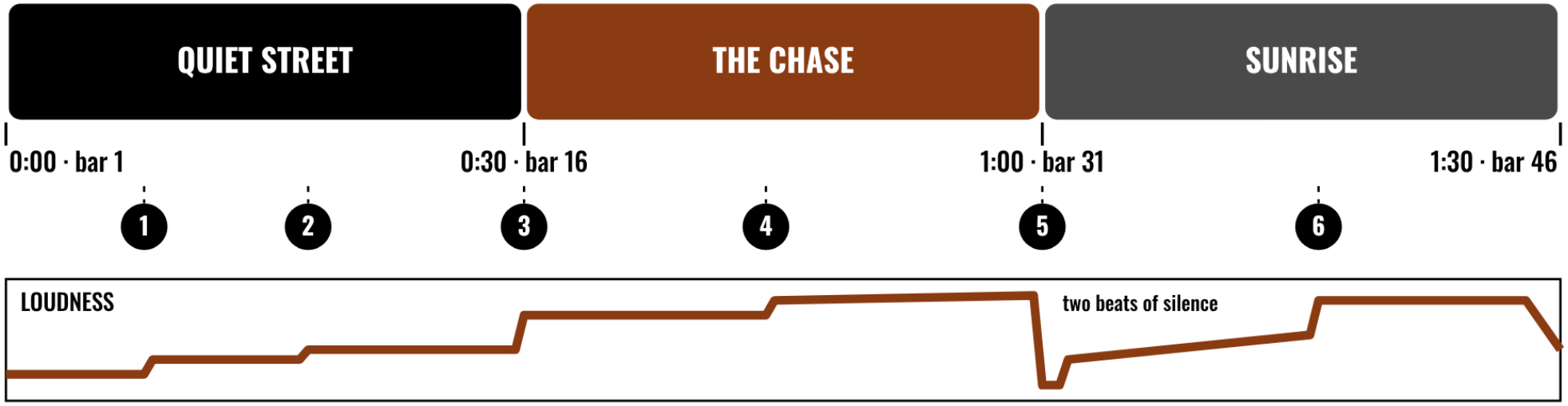
HUDSON BEAT



MUSIC FOR VISUAL MEDIA

Score the picture.

WATCH: SOUND OFF, THEN SOUND ON

SOUND OFF, THEN ON

The same scene, played twice

Teacher: play the scene once with the sound off, then with a score.

- What did the music tell you that the picture did not?
- Where did the music change when the picture changed?
- Was there a moment of silence?

WHAT DOES A SCORE DO?

- Sets the mood: tense, joyful, mysterious
- Matches the pacing of the cuts
- Follows the emotional arc
- Hits specific moments on screen
- Knows when to be quiet

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	Sound off, then on · what a score does · choose a clip · study it
CLASS 2	Timeline · markers demo · bars and seconds · plan · dynamics
CLASS 3	Working day: compose the backbone
CLASS 4	Working day: sync and refine
CLASS 5	Working day: layer, sync, shape
CLASS 6	Finalize · checklist · rubric · 3 questions
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

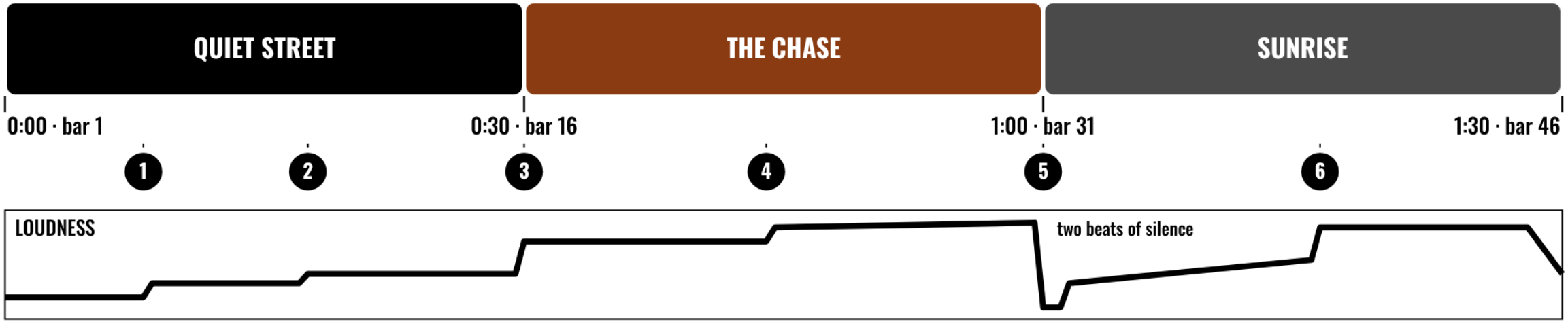
STEPS 1 AND 2: CHOOSE, STUDY

1. Find a clip of 2–3 minutes
2. Import it into Logic
3. Watch it at least 5 times
4. Note the mood, pacing and key moments
5. Fill in the Clip log and Watch notes

CHOOSE A CLIP YOU CAN USE

- 1–2 minutes of real scored content
- Few scenes, clear moments
- Your own footage, or a clip you may use
- Know where it came from
- Mute the clip’s own music

WHERE THE MUSIC HITS

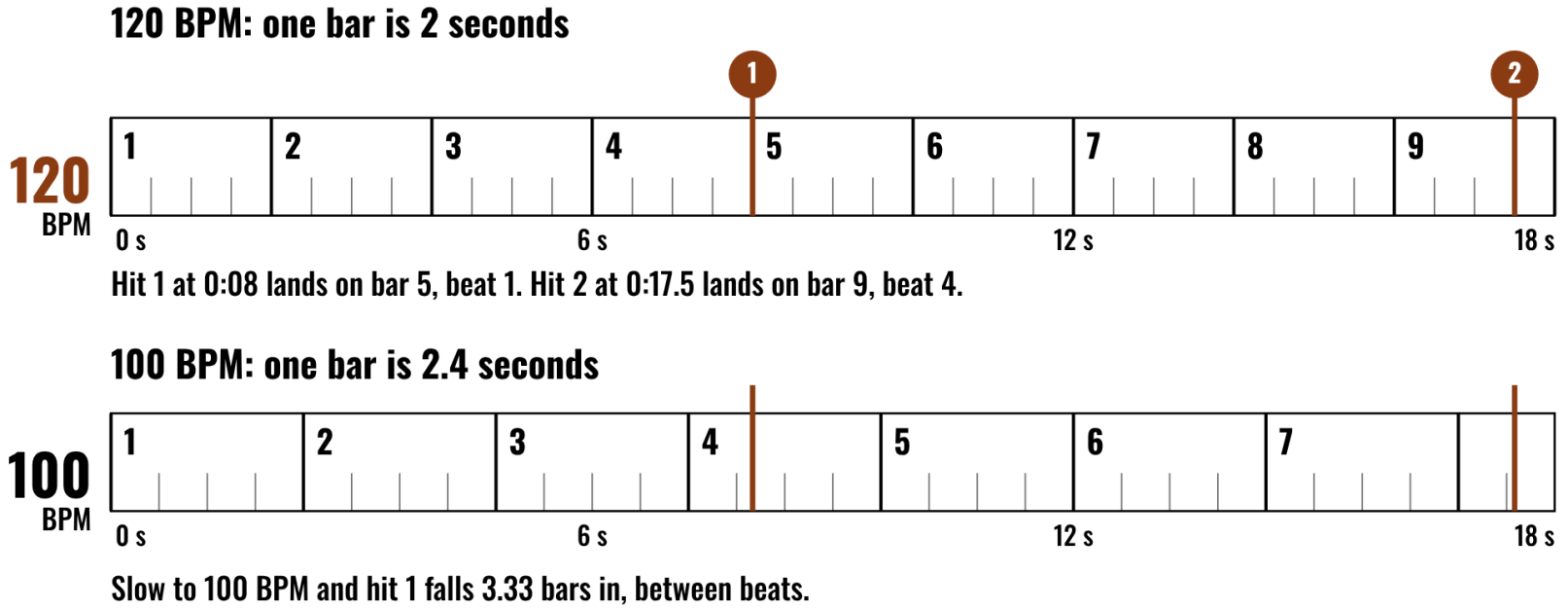


- Three scenes, six hit points
- It gets quiet before the pop
- The curve follows the picture
- Hit points sit on the timeline

WATCH ME: MARKERS IN LOGIC

1. File, Movie, Open Movie: the clip appears
2. Play it and stop on a key moment
3. Add a marker there and name it
4. Read the time in SMPTE: minutes, seconds, frames
5. Mark every moment you want to hit

WORKED EXAMPLE: BARS AND SECONDS



- A bar is four beats
- Pick a tempo that lands the hits
- Seconds divided by bar length
- Hits between beats feel loose

PLAN YOUR SCORE

1. Where does the music build?
2. Where does it drop?
3. Where does it shift?
4. Where does it hit a cue?
5. Fill in the Score plan and Cue sheet

SHAPE THE DYNAMICS



- Flat means the same all the way
- Silence is a choice
- Shape follows the story
- Loud means more after quiet

WORKING DAY: COMPOSE

- Start with the backbone
- Layer in detail
- Keep looking at the picture
- Music you like is not the goal: music that fits is

WORKING DAY: SYNC AND REFINE

- Check every hit point against the picture
- Nudge by frames, not guesses
- Add sound effects if you like
- Leave space: silence is a choice

FINALIZE AND BOUNCE

- Final mix and levels
- Bounce a .mp3 or .wav
- Put your music on the video
- Write your 3 Padlet questions

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Music for Visual Media
- [ ] Video with synced audio ready
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your video with your score
- Walk us through your choices
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You started with silence.
- You watched until you knew it.
- You hit the moments.
- Now it feels like one thing.

